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Aliança Catalana and Vox in Catalonia: united in nativism, divided by the nation

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ABSTRACT

Radical right nativist parties have gained ground across Europe in recent decades. However, a key unanswered question is how these parties adapt in contexts marked by the centre–periphery cleavage and competing national attachments. This paper addresses that question by examining the case of Catalonia and the emergence of Vox, a Spanish nationalist radical right party, and Aliança Catalana, a pro-independence, anti-immigration, and Catalan nationalist party. Although both parties align on immigration and economic concerns, they diverge on gender, climate change, LGBT + rights, and – most notably – the national cleavage and territorial issues. Voters from both parties exhibit similar socioeconomic characteristics and share concerns related to immigration, but their national attachment primarily influences their choice between AC and Vox.

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KEYWORDS Radical right; Catalonia; Vox; Aliança Catalana; nationalism

Introduction

On 17 June 2023, Silvia Orriols became mayor of Ripoll, a small town in northern Catalonia known as the founding site of Catalonia as well as the home-town of the perpetrators of the 2017 Barcelona Islamist terrorist attack. Only three years earlier, in 2020, Orriols had founded her own political movement, Aliança Catalana (AC), running on a platform that combined nativism, anti-Islam sentiment, Catalan nationalism, and pro-independence (Rius 2025; Torrens 2024). In the 2024 Catalan election, Aliança Catalana secured 119,149 votes (3.77%) and won two seats. The party fell just 3,000 votes short of

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gaining three additional seats. With AC entering the Catalan Parliament alongside the Spanish nationalist radical right party Vox, Catalonia now has two radical right parties represented in its legislature. In contrast, no radical right party had secured parliamentary representation before 2021. Several polls from 2025 indicate that AC is becoming increasingly consolidated in the Catalan party system, with projected support ranging from 6.2% to 11.9% of the vote and between 8 and 19 seats.¹

Vox and AC are not isolated cases. Nativist radical right movements have become increasingly common in Europe over the past few decades (Oesch and Rennwald 2018). Nativism considers that a state should only be inhabited by individuals from the native cultural, linguistic, ethnic, or religious group, viewing nonnative elements as a threat to the nation's homogeneity (Mudde 2007). Since the 1980s, the rise of nativist radical right parties has been widely regarded as a challenge to liberal democracies (Mudde 2007), as these parties promoted backlash towards immigrants and other minority groups (Kriesi et al. 2008). What is less common is the coexistence of multiple radical right parties within the same political system (Piccolino and Puleo 2025), despite some recent examples in France and the Netherlands (Ivaldi 2023; De Lange 2022). Specifically, the coexistence of two radical right parties with opposing national attachments is very rare. Thus, this article aims to address three key questions. First, what are the key similarities, differences, and competitive dynamics between *Aliança Catalana* and Vox? Second, how has Catalonia transitioned from the absence of significant radical right parties to the presence of two distinct radical right parties represented in its parliament? Third, how does the rise of nativism interact with the pre-existing centre–periphery cleavage?

Catalonia is a very relevant case for studying the rise of the radical right, particularly in places with competing identities and national attachments. For a long time, Catalonia, along with the rest of Spain, was considered one of the few European regions where the radical right had no significant support (Alonso and Rovira Kaltwasser 2015; Heyne and Manucci 2021; Mendes and Dennison 2021). However, between 2018 and 2021, Vox entered both the national parliament and most regional parliaments, including the culturally distinct regions of Catalonia and the Basque Country (Turnbull-Dugarte, Rama, and Santana 2020). Moreover, the emergence of *Aliança Catalana* is a remarkable phenomenon because it breaks from the traditional discourse of Catalan mainstream parties, which have always avoided an ethnic framing (Sanjaume-Calvet and Riera-Gil 2022; Vergés-Gifra and Serra 2022).

Empirically, we first examine the supply side by analysing party manifestos using both quantitative and qualitative methods. Our results show that both Vox and AC structure their political appeal primarily around nativism and anti-immigration rhetoric, with their opposing stances on the national cleavage as a secondary factor. Additionally, AC resorts to femonationalist and

homonationalist discourses, while Vox remains rooted in traditional social conservatism. Despite these differences, both parties share similar economic positions, favouring free-market policies. Then, we examine the demand side by conducting a quantitative analysis of Catalan voters based on survey data. Immigration emerges as the key factor driving support for both parties. Moreover, voters concerned about immigration tend to sort themselves between Vox and AC based on their national identity. Finally, the critical role of immigration is reinforced by evidence showing that this was the primary driver behind voters shifting from mainstream Catalan nationalist parties to AC.

The rise of the radical right in Europe

Populist Radical Right parties have become significant actors in most Western democracies, gaining renewed prominence and growing importance since the early 2000s (Oesch and Rennwald 2018). Although ongoing academic debates persist, a widely accepted approach defines populist radical right parties as those sharing a ‘core ideology that combines (at least) three features: authoritarianism, nativism, and populism’ (Mudde 2015, 296), which is the definition adopted in this article. Nativism refers to the fusion of nationalism and xenophobia, distinguishing ‘nationals’ and ‘aliens’ (Betz 2017). Calls for a strictly ordered society characterize the authoritarian dimension and often advocate harsher punishments for those who diverge from conventional values (Tillman 2021).

The success of radical right parties over the past two decades remains puzzling. Some scholars attribute their rise to globalization and economic hardship, portraying its supporters as blue-collar ‘globalization losers’ (Swank and Betz 2003; Bornschier and Kriesi 2012). Others argue that cultural concerns, especially anti-immigration attitudes, better explain their rise (Ignazi 1992; Kriesi et al. 2008; Norris and Inglehart 2019). A meta-analysis by Stockemer, Lentz, and Mayer (2018) finds only two consistent predictors: being male and opposing immigration. Oesch and Rennwald (2018) present a more structural explanation based on how economic and cultural attitudes have changed alongside the labour market over recent decades, resulting in a new social class structure. In their view, the political spectrum is divided into three poles – the left, the centre-right, and the radical right – that compete for the support of the new social classes. Specifically, the radical right competes with the left for the support of traditional blue-collar production workers, and it competes with the centre-right for the support of small business owners. The two groups have different economic views despite sharing conservative social views and opposing immigration and multiculturalism. The first group is in favour of redistribution, whereas the second supports free markets. Thus, radical right parties must balance the

demands of various groups, resulting in a range of policy positions (Ennser 2012; Rovny and Polk 2020).

Many radical right parties channel nativism through welfare chauvinist positions, which involve advocating for the exclusivity of public service provisions for nationals, arguing that these services are ineffective due to misuse by immigrants (Abts et al. 2021; Enggist and Pinggera 2022). This mixes left-leaning economics with conservative cultural views, which De Lange (2007) has classified as the 'new winning formula' for the radical right. Yet success remains context-specific (Harteveld 2016). Nevertheless, some radical right parties also blur economic stances (Rovny and Polk 2020) or support market liberalism (Rathgeb 2020). Indeed, as Ennser (2012) shows, the radical right exhibits as much policy heterogeneity as other party families like conservatives and Christian democrats.

Radical-right parties may adopt different approaches even within the same party system. Piccolino and Puleo (2025) describe the coexistence of two parties from the same party family within a single system as 'mirror parties.' According to their framework, political competition between such parties depends on whether they contest major issues, secondary issues, or both. When two parties differ only on minor issues, this is referred to as 'ideologically peripheral' competition. When they diverge on both major and minor issues, the result is 'wide-ranging' competition. Conversely, parties can be 'scarcely differentiated' by competing neither on major nor on minor issues but instead on personalities or campaign strategies. Finally, though rare, parties may present an 'ideologically central' competition by agreeing on minor topics but competing directly on major ones.

Multiple recent studies have shed light on this competition in secondary issues. First, radical right parties differ in their approach to political minorities. Some radical right parties, such as the Party of Freedom in the Netherlands (De Lange and Mügge 2015), widely employ femonationalism and homonationalism rhetoric (Spierings and Zaslove 2015; Spierings 2021), while others remain traditionally socially conservative. This entails defending gender equality, abortion rights, and LGBT+ rights using nationalist, anti-immigration, and anti-Islam arguments (Farris 2017; Puar 2018). Second, radical right parties diverge in their support for the European Union (Heinisch, McDonnell, and Werner 2021; Taggart and Pirro 2021). Third, radical right parties differ in their approach to climate change. Some deny or question its existence, while others approach the issue with caution or minimal engagement, and others recognize climate change as a serious threat (Gemenis, Katsanidou, and Vasilopoulou 2012; Schwörer and Fernández-García 2024). Lastly, radical right parties may diverge in the importance they place on non-policy issues, such as leadership evaluations, to distinguish themselves from other radical right competitors (Puleo, Carteny, and Piccolino 2025).

An additional dimension that has received less attention is the interaction between the rise of nativism and the pre-existing centre–periphery cleavage. While most parties operate at the national level and promote a nationalism rooted in the concept of the Nation-State, some adopt a sub-national orientation (Heinisch, Massetti, and Mazzoleni 2018). For example, Vlaams Belang in Belgium operates exclusively in the Flemish-speaking area and advocates a distinctly Flemish nationalism (Van Haute, Pauwels, and Sinardet 2018). Interestingly, the Lega Nord in Italy switched from a nativist regionalist discourse centred on Northern Italy to a nativist nationalism that portrays the EU as the people’s ‘enemy’ (Albertazzi, Giovannini, and Seddone 2018).

The rise of the radical right in Spain and Catalonia

Spain, and particularly Catalonia, presents an excellent case for analysing the rise of the radical right in a context where the centre–periphery cleavage is strong and competing national attachments are salient. In Spain, despite high immigration and the 2008 economic crisis, radical right parties remained absent until 2018, when Vox, a radical right party, won 10% of the seats in the Andalusia regional election (Rama et al. 2021). Since then, Vox has gained national and regional representation and joined several conservative-led regional governments. In Catalonia, Vox gained parliamentary representation in 2021, followed by Aliança Catalana in 2024.

Since Spain’s democratization in the late 1970s, the radical right in Catalonia has evolved through three phases: marginalization, reorganization, and expansion. The initial phase, from the 1970s to the early 2000s, saw the far right represented by small, politically marginal Neo-Nazi and neo-Falangist groups, often linked to skinhead movements and football hooliganism (Casals 2020). In Madrid, these groups embraced nostalgic rhetoric tied to Franco’s dictatorship and Spanish nationalism. In Barcelona, some adopted influences from French and Italian extreme right movements, though they largely remained Spanish nationalists (Casals 2020, 370).

The second phase saw the emergence of Plataforma per Catalunya (PxC), founded in 2002. Unlike earlier groups, PxC rejected violence and pursued electoral politics, focusing on anti-immigration, anti-Islam, and welfare chauvinist positions (Casals 2009; Hernández-Carr 2013). In 2007, it gained municipal seats by mobilizing anti-immigrant sentiment (Casals 2009). Although it failed to enter the Catalan parliament in 2010, PxC experienced growth in the 2011 local elections, only to decline and ultimately disappear by 2019. Distancing itself from Francoist and ultra-nationalist traditions, PxC aligned with the European ‘new far right’ while maintaining an ambiguous national stance, opposing both Catalan independence and extreme Spanish nationalism (Casals 2009). Hernández-Carr (2013) notes that many voters were former social democrats reacting to immigration and economic hardship. PxC’s

decline reflected three factors. First, internal splits in 2007 and 2010 weakened its resources. Second, the party faced social stigma, which hindered recruitment and funding (Casals 2009). Third, and most importantly, the Catalan independence movement shifted the public agenda toward the national cleavage. Thus, PxC could no longer use a blurring strategy on the territorial dimension.

The third period of the radical right in Catalonia is marked by the emergence of Vox and Aliança Catalana in the context of the debate on Catalan independence. Support for independence in Catalonia was traditionally low, but this support grew steadily, especially after the 2008 financial crisis. By 2012, all major Catalan nationalist parties advocated an independence referendum, and by 2017, nearly half of the Catalan population supported independence (Rodon 2020; Orriols and Rodon 2016). The 2017 referendum, unrecognized by Spain, led to clashes and arrests, which were seen as repression by Catalan nationalists. Since 2018, the new Spanish government has implemented conciliatory measures, including pardons and amnesty, and support for independence has declined. The referendum polarized Catalonia, making national identity the key political factor (Rodon 2020; Orriols and Rodon 2016). This polarization also impacted the rest of Spain, sparking a resurgence in Spanish nationalism and the rise of Vox, which broke the taboo against the radical right (Rama et al. 2021).

Turnbull-Dugarte (2019) argues that Vox's 2018 breakthrough in Andalusia was driven mainly by the centre–periphery cleavage after the failed 2017 Catalan referendum. Likewise, Turnbull-Dugarte, Rama, and Santana (2020) show that a strong Spanish identity increases Vox support, particularly among those who are politically dissatisfied. Heyne and Manucci (2021) add that pro-centralization is crucial, alongside anti-immigration, anti-feminism, and anti-globalization. Marcos-Marne, Plaza-Colodro, and O'Flynn (2024) also emphasize territorial preferences while acknowledging the limited role of populist attitudes. The centrality of the centre–periphery divide distinguishes Vox voters from many radical right European cases, where territorial issues are weaker and post-materialist values predominate. Key socio-demographics associated with Vox voting include being male, middle-aged, religious, with a middle or high income, and holding an upper-secondary education (Turnbull-Dugarte, Rama, and Santana 2020; Heyne and Manucci 2021).

How can we explain the rise of the radical right in Catalonia, moving from no representation to two radical-right parties in less than five years? On the one hand, the emergence of PxC suggests that several conditions for the emergence of a radical-right party were already present. However, the party struggled with the dominant centre–periphery cleavage. Their blurring strategy, although initially effective, led to the party's collapse as the importance of national attachment grew with the start of the pro-independence movement. We can speculate that if the territorial divide had been less

severe, PxC might have become an established yet minor party within the Catalan party system by focusing only on nativism and anti-Islam positions.

In this sense, the increasing salience of the national cleavage initially prevented the formation of a successful nativist party in Catalonia. As political competition centred on the independence question rather than on immigration, no new nativist party could gain relevance. However, after the 2017 referendum, positions on both sides of the territorial divide radicalized. On the Spanish-nationalist side, Vox emerged by first competing on a strongly pro-centralization and Spanish-nationalist platform, and only later incorporating anti-immigration positions into its strategy. On the Catalan-nationalist side, Aliança Catalana eventually arose as a response within part of the pro-independence electorate, combining nativist, anti-Islam, and pro-independence appeals. As a result, the growing polarization of national attachments created an opportunity to combine nationalism with nativist values, even when Catalan nationalism had previously been civic (Sanjaume-Calvet and Riera-Gil 2022; Vergés-Gifra and Serra 2022).

Aliança Catalana was founded in 2020 by Sílvia Orriols, a city council member of Ripoll, a town in northern Catalonia renowned for its historical significance, as it is considered the birthplace of Catalonia during the Middle Ages. Ripoll has experienced substantial North African immigration over the last decades, leading to social tensions (Torrens 2024). Moreover, the town gained notoriety as the hometown of several perpetrators of the 2017 Barcelona jihadist attacks, which intensified xenophobic and Islamophobic sentiments (Torrens 2024; Rius 2025). In this context, Orriols won a city council seat in the 2019 local elections with 9.44% of the vote, running under the banner of the fringe far-right party Front Nacional de Catalunya, from which she split in 2020 to create Aliança Catalana. AC won a plurality in the 2023 local elections, securing 30.76% of the vote, and Orriols was elected mayor.

In the 2024 Catalan election, Aliança Catalana emerged as the second radical right party with representation in the Catalan parliament. It won 119,149 votes (3.77%) and gained two seats. It narrowly missed three more seats by falling short of the threshold in the Barcelona district. Aliança Catalana combines anti-immigration and anti-Islam stances with the defense of Catalan independence and a broader agenda of Catalan nationalism (Rius 2025; Torrens 2024). AC is the first party with parliamentary representation combining nativism with Catalan nationalism. Until now, nativist views have been primarily associated with Spanish nationalism, whereas Catalan nationalism has typically been viewed as civic rather than ethnic (Sanjaume-Calvet and Riera-Gil 2022; Vergés-Gifra and Serra 2022). Moreover, some commentators propose that the party adopt a more modern approach and draw inspiration from contemporary radical right leaders, such as Marine Le Pen. For example, Torrens (2024, 166–168) highlights that AC supports

some progressive social issues like LGBT rights, abortion, euthanasia, and women's rights following a homonationalist and femonationalist rhetoric (Farris 2017; Puar 2018).

The rise of AC can be interpreted in two different ways. First, the rise of AC is the byproduct of the failed Catalan independence movement. AC has become an appealing alternative for voters, mainly those concerned with Catalan independence, who are disillusioned with the main Catalan nationalist parties, the centre-right Junts² and the centre-left ERC, following the failed independence attempt in 2017. Some radical voters criticize these parties for their perceived betrayals, citing their recent support for the Spanish government in exchange for conciliatory measures. Thus, AC positions itself as the uncompromising defender of Catalan independence.

Second, the emergence of Aliança Catalana may represent a more structural change within Catalan society. Its growth may be fuelled by rising public concern about immigration, as was the case with the emergence of PxC in the late 2000s. For instance, according to the Centre d'Estudis d'Opinió (CEO), the Catalan public opinion research institute, immigration has risen from the 10th to the 3rd most important issue for Catalans between 2022 and 2025. Moreover, the polarization that clearly divides the Catalan population into those against and those in favour of independence creates a double opportunity for blending the nativist sentiment already present in part of the population with the more radical views of each side of the national attachment divide. Thus, the polarization of the national axis allows AC to present a coherent policy package that combines Catalan nationalism with nativist and anti-immigration messages, as it does for Vox regarding Spanish nationalism.

Explaining Aliança Catalana and Vox in Catalonia

In this section, we outline our theoretical expectations regarding the three research questions we pose. The first of these asks: What are the key similarities, differences, and competitive dynamics between Aliança Catalana and Vox? Early journalistic accounts (Rius 2025; Torrens 2024) portray AC as a populist, radical-right party that combines nativism and anti-Islamic stances with Catalan nationalism and independence. We test this by analysing its electoral supply. Drawing on the 'mirror parties' concept (Piccolino and Puleo 2025), we expect AC and Vox to share key traits while also differentiating themselves, with contrasts ranging from 'ideologically peripheral' (secondary issues) to 'wide-ranging' (encompassing both primary and secondary issues).

Nevertheless, the first difference seems evident, as each one caters to a different side of the national spectrum within Catalonia. AC champions Catalan independence while Vox promotes centralization within Spain.

The other difference between the two is that Vox is traditionally portrayed as more economically liberal and conservative than other European radical right parties (Ferreira 2019). In contrast, AC may resemble other radical European right actors by adopting welfare chauvinism, femonationalism, and homonationalism. Thus, we propose the following two hypotheses:

Hypothesis 1: Aliança Catalana and Vox in Catalonia are both nativist parties, yet they differ in their national attachments.

Hypothesis 2: Aliança Catalana will make more claims linked to welfare chauvinism, femonationalism, and homonationalism, while Vox in Catalonia presents more economically liberal and socially traditionalist positions.

Our second research question examines how to explain the sudden emergence of both AC and Vox in Catalonia, as the party system moved from having no radical-right representation to two of such parties in just a few years. This question is closely connected to our third, which explores the role of the centre–periphery cleavage in the rise of nativism. We approach both questions by studying the electoral demand for the radical right in Catalonia. One potential explanation is that the Catalan independence movement's failure paved the way for more radical actors to rise to prominence by criticizing the traditional Catalan parties for being too accommodating in their pacts with the Spanish government. As a result, we can expect AC voters to be mainly driven by the national cleavage, including those who have switched from one of the traditional Catalan parties to AC.

The alternative explanation is that the high polarization around the national axis facilitated mobilization around nativist values, which, in part, were preexisting (Hernández-Carr 2013) but may also have increased due to recent migratory waves. When polarization on the territorial dimension was low, political entrepreneurs seeking to mobilize support through nativism faced difficulties appealing to voters with diverse national identities. Nativist appeals often lack clarity regarding the specific in-group they aim to protect, making their reference group ambiguous, which was an evident problem for PxC (Casals 2009; Hernández-Carr 2013). The high polarization surrounding national identity following the 2017 Catalan referendum created space for new political actors to emerge by blending nativist appeals to national attachments rooted in cultural and linguistic differences. Vox capitalized on its staunch opposition to Catalan nationalism and included nativist and anti-immigration rhetoric as secondary themes (Ferreira 2019).

Conversely, AC gained traction by positioning itself against the traditional Catalan nationalist parties, which some radical pro-independence voters viewed as too moderate. AC branded itself as the more extreme pro-independence option, blending these claims with nativist and anti-Islam positions to attract a broader set of voters. In both cases, the radical positions in the identitarian axis make their nativist claims credible. As polarization increased, it

enabled the rise of two distinct parties, each appealing to opposite sides of the divide. In other words, Catalonia's 'winning formula' combines nativism with a radical stance on one side of the territorial axis, clearly aligned with a specific national attachment.

By analysing voter behaviour in the 2024 Catalan election, we can identify which explanation is most accurate. If the first explanation holds, we should expect the main driver of the vote towards AC, as well as towards Vox, to be linked to the national cleavage. Moreover, we should expect that voters who switch from the mainstream Catalan parties to AC will also be motivated by their concern about the national cleavage. Alternatively, the success of both parties may be linked to nativist mobilization. In that case, we should expect concerns about immigration to be the primary driver of voting towards AC and Vox, with national identity playing a secondary role. In such a situation, voters concerned about immigration who identify as Catalan are more likely to support AC, whereas those who identify as Spanish are inclined to vote for Vox. Additionally, concerns about immigration – and not independence – should drive vote switching from Junts and ERC towards AC. Thus, we propose the two following competing hypotheses.

Hypothesis 3: The vote for Aliança Catalana and Vox is mainly driven by voters concerned about the national cleavage.

Hypothesis 4: The vote for Aliança Catalana and Vox is mainly driven by voters concerned about immigration.

Data and methods

To test our hypotheses, we rely on a combination of qualitative and quantitative methods that assess both the political supply and demand of the radical right in the 2024 Catalan elections. The first empirical analysis covers the political supply by analysing the electoral manifestos of both AC and Vox in 2024. We manually coded all the sentences from these manifestos using the Spanish framework of the Comparative Agenda Project (CAP) (Chaqués-Bonafont, Baumgartner, and Palau 2015), which identifies 23 key issue categories. To adapt the CAP framework to the specific context of Catalonia, we have added a new category that addresses the national cleavage, focusing on issues such as support for or opposition to Catalan independence and its associated topics. Furthermore, we provide a qualitative assessment of each party's positions and rhetoric on several key issues, including nativism, welfare chauvinism, and the national cleavage, as well as on various secondary topics, such as gender, LGBT + rights, and climate change.

For the second analysis, we examine the political demand for radical right parties by studying voters' behaviour. For that, we rely on the post-electoral survey (study number 3464) conducted by the Centro de Investigaciones

Sociológicas (CIS). We use this survey because it has a large sample ($n = 3,999$)³ and captures more AC voters than other public datasets. Overall, 4.15% reported voting for AC, 6.6% for Vox, 13.49% abstained, and 75.77% for other parties. Our dependent variable is the self-reported vote for the six parties with seats in the 2024 election. Given its nominal nature, we estimate a multinomial logistic regression model with ‘non-voting’ as the reference category.

Our main independent variable captures concerns over immigration or the national cleavage. The survey lacks direct questions on voters’ top issue priorities, which is a clear limitation, but it asks, in an open-ended format, which topics parties and candidates debated most. We code these responses with a modified CAP scheme, generating dummies for mentions of immigration, law and crime, or the national cleavage. We include law and crime, as this is often conflated with immigration in public debate. This is not an ideal measure of immigration salience, but it is the only feasible one available with the current data. In addition, we include a set of control variables. First, we control for national attachment as this is one of the main predictors of vote choice in Catalonia. We use a modified version of the Moreno question with the options equally Spanish and Catalan, more or only Catalan, and more or only Spanish. Then, we account for a range of socio-demographic attributes, including gender, age, urban residence, university education, and employment status. Lastly, we incorporate a series of attitudinal variables, such as whether the respondent is a practicing religious person, their self-assessed position on the left-right ideological spectrum, and their level of political interest.

The political supply of the radical right in the 2024 Catalan election

We begin analysing the political supply of each radical right party in the 2024 Catalan elections by examining the manifestos issued by AC and Vox during the election. [Figure 1](#) illustrates the distribution of attention allocated to each topic by both parties. Both parties prioritize topics related to Law and Crime, the National Cleavage, and Macroeconomics with a similar percentage. Interestingly, while both parties have Immigration among their most debated topics, Vox stresses it much more than AC. Additionally, notable variations emerge when examining the other top issues each party covers. AC focuses on Education and Culture, while Vox focuses on the Environment and Domestic Commerce. These differences partly reflect their opposing stances on the national cleavage, as AC emphasizes Education and Culture, which are deeply intertwined with identitarian debates in Catalonia (Sanjaume-Calvet and Riera-Gil [2022](#); Vergés-Gifra and Serra [2022](#)). Moreover,

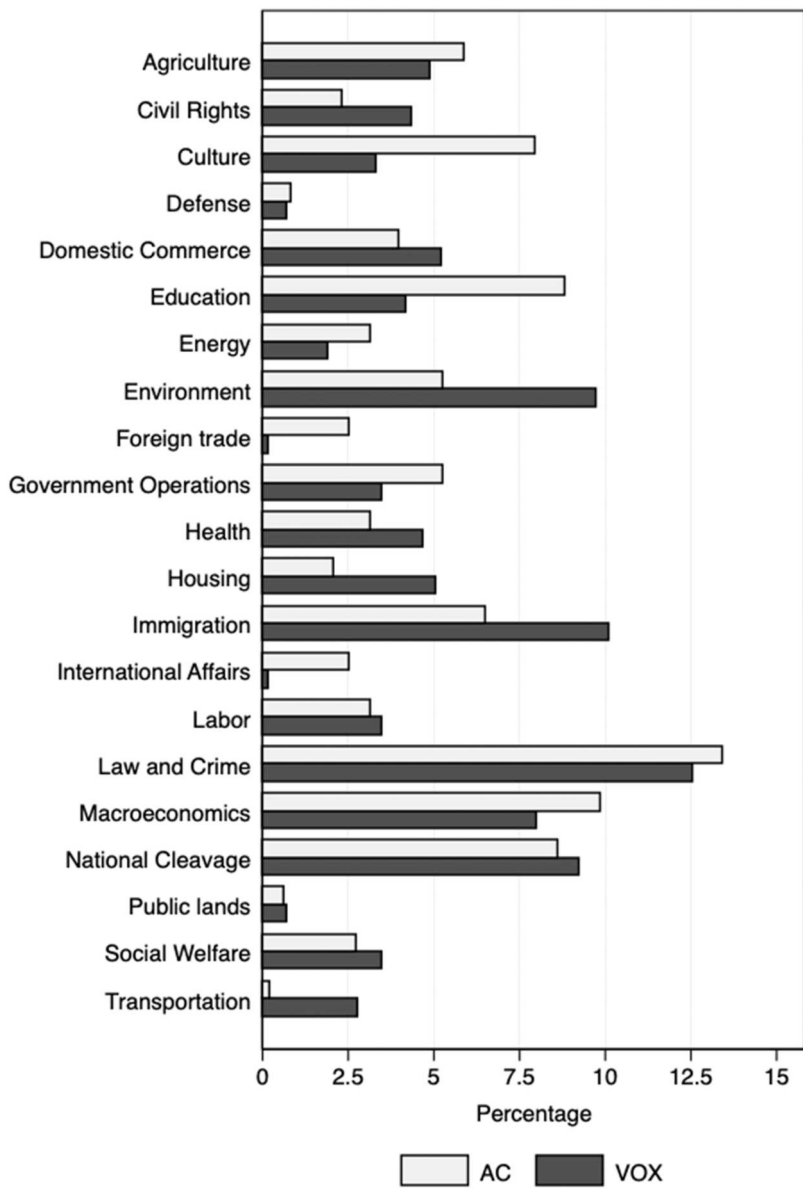


Figure 1. Topic salience among AC and Vox manifestos (Comparative Agendas Project codebook).
Note: The codes are listed in alphabetical order. To see the full distribution of topics in each party, see Appendix A.

the Environment emerges as Vox’s third most common topic, reflecting its consistent focus on this issue and clear stance as a climate policy obstructionist (Hanson 2024).

Now, we qualitatively compare the positions of both parties by analysing their rhetoric and specific policy proposals on several prominent issues. Appendix B provides many excerpts as examples of these codes for both parties. First, regarding Law and Crime, both parties share remarkably similar positions (see excerpts 31–40). They associate the perceived lack of safety with immigration and emphasize addressing squatters ('Okupas'), advocating for measures to expedite their eviction. Additionally, both Vox and AC propose increasing funding for the police and tightening the penal code, which corresponds with the authoritarian dimension of the radical right.

Then, both parties adopt similar approaches to immigration (excerpts 24–30). On the one hand, they frame immigration on similar terms to other radical right parties, as they advocate for the expulsion of 'illegal' immigrants, as well as those who commit crimes:

Aliança Catalana will apply the Immigration Law, deporting criminal immigrants and repatriating illegal immigrants (AC 2024, 3)

We will expel all illegal immigrants and legal immigrants who commit serious crimes or make petty crime their way of life (Vox 2024, 7)

Moreover, both parties employ welfare-chauvinist rhetoric, emphasizing that public benefits should be reserved for 'nationals' and blaming immigration for straining public service provision. For example:

Hospitals, schools, the welfare state, or natural resources cannot withstand the migratory avalanche suffered by Catalonia (AC 2024, 1)

We will establish a national priority in access to social assistance and housing assistance. (Vox 2024, 8)

Thus, they both convey the traditional message of radical right parties, albeit with local issues. AC and Vox place special attention on 'MENAs' (unaccompanied migrant minors, mainly from Northern and Western Africa), portraying them as a safety threat and proposing their expulsion (see excerpts 24 and 27). Similarly, AC and Vox's economic agendas are closely aligned (excerpts 1–4). Both advocate for tax cuts to stimulate industry and growth, reject redistributive taxes such as inheritance, donation, and wealth taxes, and criticize public overspending. While using welfare-chauvinistic arguments on immigration, they adopt a clear pro-market stance on macroeconomic and fiscal policy. They also highlight tourism as a key engine of regional prosperity. This contrasts with other 'mirror parties' in the radical right, such as the French case (Ivaldi 2023), where one party tends to hold more free-market positions and the other holds statist ones.

On education, both parties diverge despite shared concerns (excerpts 10–15). Both cite poor PISA results and oppose current pedagogical trends,

favouring merit-based systems and supporting further cooperation with the private sector. However, Vox denounces ‘ideological content’ in education, targeting gender and sexual education, interpretations of Francoism, and Catalan language use. It proposes reducing the role of the Catalan language in schools. Conversely, AC laments the declining presence of Catalan and seeks to reinforce its use. In this regard, Culture is central for AC but marginal for Vox (see excerpts 41–44). AC defends Catalan traditions and the preservation of architectural and artistic heritage. Despite not prioritizing culture, Vox promotes Spanish traditions, such as bullfighting, and supports the protection of military buildings and symbols.

Environmental issues show stark contrasts between the two parties. Though Vox ranks the environment fifth in importance, it denies human-driven climate change and opposes the ‘elitist green agenda’. AC, meanwhile, acknowledges climate change and actively supports renewable energy, a stance that Vox critiques (excerpts 16–19). Nevertheless, both support expanding nuclear energy (excerpts 20–23). This aligns AC more closely with France’s *Rassemblement National*, while Vox’s denialism resembles that of *Alternative für Deutschland* (Schwörer and Fernández-García 2024).

Now, we focus on how these parties address gender and LGBT + issues as the use of femonationalism and homonationalism is a dividing feature within the fourth wave of the radical right (Spierings and Zaslove 2015). While not among the most prominent⁴, these topics reveal significant ideological and rhetorical differences between the two parties. As identified previously (Pichel-Vázquez and Enguix Grau 2021; Ferreira 2019), Vox adopts an ultra-conservative position, rejecting the concept of gender-based violence and advocating for the repeal of all LGBT + protections. In contrast, AC acknowledges the existence of gender-based violence and normalizes same-sex families. For example:

We will strengthen units specialized in the prevention and fight against gender-based violence, not only in an eventual way as now but with operational patrols that control misogynistic acts against women and girls and provide a concrete and adequate response to each case. (AC 2024, 9)

We understand as family the union of people by blood or affective ties, we will always defend mutual affection and support: regardless of whether they are traditional, single parent, or homosexual couples, we will always be with Catalan families. (AC 2024, 7)

We will repeal gender laws that undermine the equality of Spaniards, pit men and women against each other, and create first and second-class victims. (Vox 2024, 4)

We will repeal Law 11/2014 of 10 October to guarantee the rights of lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, and intersex people and to eradicate homophobia, biphobia, and transphobia. (Vox 2024, 5)

This positions AC as a clear homonationalist and femonationalist radical right party, combining an anti-immigration agenda with support for gender equality and LGBT + families, if they are ‘Catalan.’ Finally, we find a clear difference between both parties regarding the national cleavage, their third most salient issue (see excerpts 45–52). Vox portrays the Catalan pro-independence movement as criminal and totalitarian, advocating for Spanish nationalism and a strong central state. In contrast, AC supports the unilateral declaration of Catalan independence, firmly aligning itself with a Catalan nationalist position. This sharp divergence shows the centrality of the territorial issue in distinguishing the two parties.

As summarized in [Table 1](#), our supply-side analysis shows that Vox and AC align on Law and Order, Immigration, and Macroeconomics but diverge significantly on Environmental issues, Gender and LGBT + rights, and, notably, the national cleavage. This cleavage is the only prominent issue among their top six where their positions are entirely opposed, highlighting their distinct national attachments. Thus, our first hypothesis is supported. Conversely, our analysis offers mixed support for our second hypothesis. While both parties occasionally use welfare chauvinist rhetoric, they generally adhere to free-market principles, contrary to our expectations. AC acknowledges gender-based violence and normalizes same-sex families, aligning with our hypothesis. This places AC close to parties like the Party for Freedom in the Netherlands or the Danish People’s Party (Spierings and Zaslove 2015). In contrast, Vox opposes these issues, placing it in the traditionalist wing of the radical right, like Poland’s Law and Justice (Gwiazda 2021). Lastly, in terms of the type of competition between these two ‘mirror parties,’ the results show that AC and Vox compete on several secondary topics but agree on the economy. Moreover, AC gives higher salience to topics closely intertwined with the national cleavage, like education and culture, which Vox dismisses. They critically disagree on one major topic, the national cleavage, despite sharing their nativist positions and concerns about immigration. The rivalry between the two parties goes beyond a merely ‘ideologically peripheral’ competition, encompassing disagreements on several secondary issues and, crucially, on the national cleavage – a central theme in Catalan politics. Yet, because both parties share nativist positions as a core element of their identity, their relationship cannot be fully classified as ‘wide-ranging competition,’ even if it comes close to that characterization.

Voting for the radical right in the 2024 Catalan election

Our second analysis addresses AC and Vox from the demand side, focusing on their voters during the 2024 Catalan election. We use the CIS post-electoral study to explain their success, as well as the role that the national cleavage

Table 1. Summary of the positions of Aliança Catalana and Vox on selected topics.

Topic	Vox	Aliança Catalana	Comparison
Law and crime	– Demands tightening the penal code – Associates lack of safety with immigration – Squatters ('okupas') presented as a major problem	– Demands tightening the penal code – Associates lack of safety with immigration – Squatters ('okupas') presented as a major problem	Similar position
Immigration	– Demands the expulsion of 'illegal' or 'criminal' immigrants – Proposes prioritizing 'nationals' over immigrants for social assistance – Presents the presence of unaccompanied immigrant minors ('MENAs') as a major safety issue	– Demands the expulsion of 'illegal' or 'criminal' immigrants – Associates the number of immigrants with problems in the provision of welfare state services – Presents the presence of unaccompanied immigrant minors ('MENAs') as a major safety issue	Similar position
Macroeconomics	– Proposes generalized tax cuts to incentivize economic growth and industry – Criticizes inheritance and wealth taxes	– Proposes generalized tax cuts to stimulate economic growth and industry – Criticizes inheritance and wealth taxes	Similar position
Education	– Proposes implementing merit-based systems – Supports increased cooperation with the private sector and charter schools – Denounces 'ideological content' in education, targeting gender and sexual education, as well as interpretations of the dictatorship – Proposes reducing the role of the Catalan language in schools	– Proposes implementing merit-based systems – Supports further cooperation with the private sector and charter schools – Proposes reinforcing the presence of Catalan in schools	Partially different position
National cleavage	– Strong Spanish nationalism – Portrays the Catalan pro-independence movement as criminal and totalitarian – Proposes a centralized Spanish State	– Strong Catalan nationalism – Proposes a unilateral declaration of independence	Different position
Environment and Climate Change	– Denies anthropogenic climate change – Criticizes renewable sources and supports nuclear energy	– Acknowledges climate change and its consequences – Supports the development of both renewable and nuclear energy	Different position

(Continued)

Table 1. Continued.

Topic	Vox	Aliança Catalana	Comparison
Culture	– Proposes reinforcing Spanish traditions and national symbols	– Defends Catalan traditions and the preservation of architectural and artistic heritage	Different position
Gender and LGTB +	– Rejects the concept of gender-based violence and advocates repealing all LGBT+ protections	– Acknowledges gender-based violence and normalizes same-sex ('Catalan') couples	Different position

plays in it. Table 2 presents the average profile of Vox and AC's voters in comparison to the average value in the survey. Vox and AC voters share a similar profile in terms of gender and age: their voters are predominantly male, with women making up only around 30%, and their average age ranges from 42 to 48 years old. However, they differ in education levels. AC voters tend to be more educated, with 43% holding a university degree compared to 34% of Vox voters. Additionally, AC voters are more likely to live in urban areas,

Table 2. Characteristics of Voters in Catalonia.

	Min	Max	Mean	Vox Mean	AC mean	Vox Diff.	AC Diff.
Woman	0	1	0.477	0.336	0.306	−0.146***	−0.175***
Age	18	94	51.500	43.825	42.521	−7.669***	−8.834***
Urban dweller	0	1	0.262	0.245	0.340	−0.016	0.085*
University Educated	0	1	0.488	0.345	0.431	−0.162***	−0.069
Retired	0	1	0.253	0.109	0.056	−0.142***	−0.195***
Employed	0	1	0.497	0.537	0.708	0.033	0.211***
Unemployed	0	1	0.050	0.096	0.028	0.050*	−0.022
Self-employed	0	1	0.132	0.192	0.146	0.061*	0.011
Churchgoer	0	1	0.092	0.170	0.028	0.091***	−0.060***
Left-Right ideology	1	10	4.440	7.886	5.957	3.694***	1.591***
Political interest	1	5	3.352	3.515	3.583	0.132	0.199
Nation: None or other	0	1	0.044	0.017	0.021	−0.024**	−0.020
Nation: More or only Spanish	0	1	0.099	0.328	0.007	0.244***	−0.097***
Nation: Equally Spanish and Catalan	0	1	0.414	0.638	0.194	0.248***	−0.220***
Nation: More or only Catalan	0	1	0.443	0.017	0.778	−0.468***	0.337***
Campaign: Immigration	0	1	0.048	0.131	0.188	0.089***	0.145***
Campaign: Law and Crime	0	1	0.020	0.039	0.007	0.020	−0.014
Campaign: National Cleavage	0	1	0.564	0.572	0.507	−0.009	−0.077
Observations	3999	3999	3999	229	144	3469	3469

Notes: The table displays the minimum and maximum values of each variable, as well as its mean value, for all respondents and those who declared voting for Vox or AC in the 2024 Catalan election. The last two columns show the difference between the general average and that for the voters of Vox and AC.

* $p < 0.05$, ** $p < 0.01$, *** $p < 0.001$.

while Vox voters are less likely to have a university degree. Regarding employment status, AC received over-average support from employed individuals, while Vox received support from unemployed and self-employed individuals. One notable difference is that Vox obtained more support from regular churchgoers, as highlighted in previous studies (Turnbull-Dugarte, Rama, and Santana 2020). Specifically, 17% of Vox's voters attend mass regularly, compared to only 2% of AC voters.

Vox and AC voters do not display higher political interest than the average citizen, contradicting previous findings that emphasized Vox voters' higher levels (Turnbull-Dugarte, Rama, and Santana 2020). Regarding ideology, Vox supporters place themselves at 7.8 on a 0–10 left-right scale, while AC voters average 5.9. Both are significantly higher than the population average of 4.4, but Vox voters are self-positioned much further to the right than AC voters. This aligns with earlier research, which shows that Catalan nationalist voters often identify more with the left than their non-nationalist peers with similar socioeconomic views (Guinjoan and Rodon 2014; Dinas 2012). Patterns of national identity reflect Catalonia's territorial polarization (Orriols and Rodon 2016; Rodon 2020). Most Vox voters identify as being equally Spanish and Catalan, or more Spanish, with only 1% identifying as more Catalan. In contrast, 77% of AC voters identify as more or only Catalan, and just 19% see themselves as equally Spanish and Catalan. Finally, when asked about the key campaign issue, 13% of Vox and 18% of AC voters named immigration, a figure significantly higher than the 4% of the general electorate, while no notable differences emerged on law and crime. On Catalan independence and the national cleavage, 56% of all voters considered it the main issue, with similar levels among Vox (57%) and AC voters (50%).

Next, we pass to our multivariate analysis. Figure 2 displays the coefficients of a multinomial regression model, which estimates the probability of voting for AC or Vox, with non-voting serving as the reference category. A positive coefficient indicates a higher likelihood of voting for the party compared to not voting at all. Here, we present the results for our two parties of interest; however, the whole model, including all parties, is available in Appendix D.

We begin by discussing the main socio-demographic and attitudinal variables, as it is remarkable how similarly these variables behave for both Vox and AC. Women are less likely to vote for either party, although the coefficients only reach the 90% confidence level ($p < 0.1$). Additionally, middle-aged voters are more likely to vote for either of the two parties, as shown by the coefficients for age and age squared, with the relation being stronger for AC. Interestingly, the variables related to urban status, university education, or employment situation do not reach conventional levels of statistical significance for either party. Meanwhile, regular churchgoers are slightly less likely to vote for AC. Regarding attitudinal variables, both parties attract

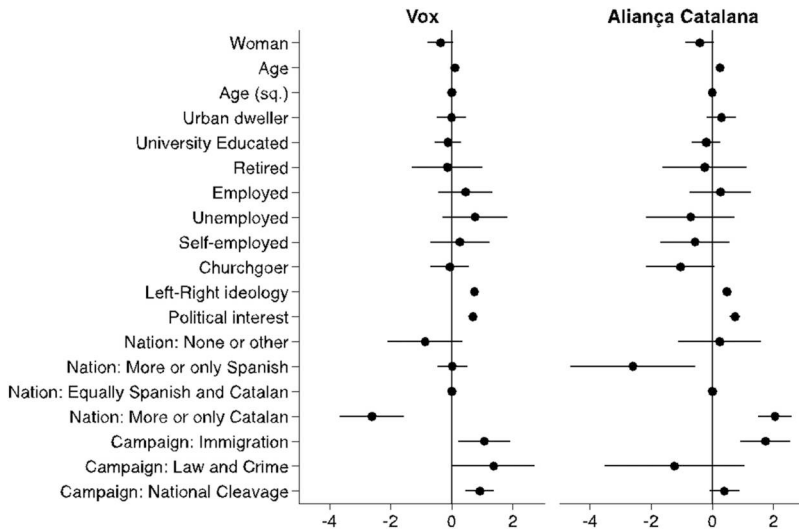


Figure 2. Determinants of voting for Vox and AC in the 2024 Catalan election.

Note: The dots are the point estimates, and the horizontal lines represent the 95% confidence intervals. The online supporting information shows the Full regression output in Appendix D.

right-leaning voters, as the coefficients for left-right self-placement are statistically significant for both Vox and AC. However, the effect is stronger for Vox. Politically interested individuals are also more likely to vote for either party. Still, this association must be interpreted cautiously, as political interest is positively associated with voting for any party compared to not voting.

Next, we examine our main variables of interest. First, considering immigration as the main issue of the campaign significantly increases the likelihood of voting for both Vox and AC, with a stronger effect for AC. Both coefficients are statistically significant, but the association is more pronounced for AC. For example, keeping the rest of the values at their means, the likelihood of voting for AC increases from 2 to 9% if the person considers that immigration was the campaign's central issue. In contrast, immigration concerns do not appear to influence voting for centre-right parties, such as PP or Junts. Interestingly, concern about law and crime is positively associated with voting for Vox but not for AC.

Regarding Catalan independence, considering it 'the most important issue of the campaign' is positively associated with voting for Vox but not with voting for AC. Thus, voters who consider Catalan independence the most relevant issue of the campaign but are likely to oppose it are more likely to mobilize in favour of Vox compared to non-voters. The national attachment plays a critical role. Identifying as 'more or only Catalan' is strongly negatively associated with voting for Vox but positively associated with voting for AC. Conversely, identifying oneself as 'more or only Spanish' is negatively

associated with voting for AC, taking 'equally Spanish and Catalan' as the reference category. To further support our analysis, we run an interaction between national attachment and considering immigration as the most important topic of the campaign. The results show that identifying as 'more Spanish' or 'equally Spanish and Catalan' and considering immigration as the main campaign issue is positively associated with voting for Vox. On the other hand, identifying as 'more Catalan' and considering immigration a key issue is positively associated with voting for AC.⁵

Preliminarily, we can conclude that Vox and AC attract voters with similar socio-demographic profiles. Their voters tend to be male, middle-aged, right-leaning, and politically interested. More importantly, voters of both parties are concerned about immigration. However, their voters differ significantly in their views on national identity, with Vox voters favouring a Spanish national identity and AC voters being more aligned with a Catalan identity. These differences provide evidence in support of the fourth hypothesis while refuting the third one. The support for Vox and AC seems to be driven by immigration, and not by mobilization around the national cleavage. Still, the national attachment plays a key role in electorally sorting, pushing voters who share concerns about immigration to support different parties.

We now turn to an analysis of vote-switching dynamics as additional evidence to support our preliminary results. If the leading mobilizer of AC is either Catalan independence or immigration, we should expect voters concerned with those issues to be more likely to switch to AC from one of the mainstream Catalan parties. Thus, we calculate the probability of switching the vote to AC among those who voted for Junts or ERC in the 2021 election. In our survey, out of the 144 individuals who declared voting for AC in 2024, 41% declared voting for Junts in 2021, while 21% voted for ERC.

Including the same variables as before, [Figure 3](#) presents the results of a logistic regression, showing the likelihood of voting for AC in 2024 among self-declared voters of Junts ($n = 552$) and ERC ($n = 692$) in 2021.⁶ Regarding socio-economic attributes, middle-aged Junts voters were likelier to switch to AC, while those with a university education were less likely to switch. Moreover, personal attributes do not appear to be associated with switching votes from ERC to AC, although women were less likely to do so. Still, the coefficients only reached a 90% confidence level ($p < 0.1$). Interestingly, those who considered themselves more right-leaning in either party were more likely to switch their votes.

Regarding the most important topic, voters who viewed the national cleavage as the central issue of the campaign were not more likely to switch their vote to AC. The coefficient for both parties is negative, with Junts reaching the 90% confidence level. Conversely, immigration shows a positive and statistically significant coefficient. Voters who supported Junts or ERC in 2021 and now consider immigration the central issue are significantly more likely to vote for AC in the 2024 election. This analysis reinforces the idea that

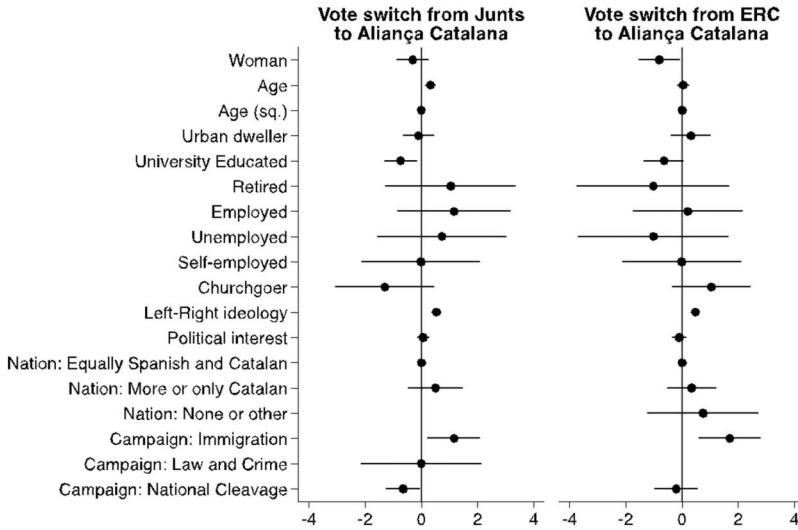


Figure 3. Determinants of vote switching from Junts to AC in the 2024 Catalan election. Note: The dots are the point estimates, and the horizontal lines represent the 90% confidence intervals. The online supporting information shows the full regression output in Appendix E.

immigration, rather than mobilization around Catalan independence, is the primary driver behind voting for AC. Thus, we reject our fourth hypothesis.

To strengthen our results, in Appendix F we replicate all three regression analyses using data from the Catalan Center for Opinion Studies (CEO), which explicitly asks respondents about the ‘main problem in Catalonia’ rather than the most debated topic during the campaign. Although these data come from periodic barometers conducted in the months following the 2024 Catalan elections, the results remain consistent with our original analyses.

In summary, both analyses regarding vote choice and vote switching support the notion that concerns about immigration are the primary driver of support for the radical right in Catalonia. Thus, we can confirm hypothesis 4 and reject hypothesis 3. Across all analyses of voter behaviour, mobilization around immigration and nativism is associated with voting for Aliança Catalana or Vox. Only for the latter does the national cleavage play a role. Nevertheless, the national attachment acts as a crucial channel through which voters translate their concerns about immigration into actual vote choice: those with a Catalan attachment tend to support AC, whereas those with a Spanish attachment tend to support Vox.

Conclusion

The rise of nativist radical right political parties across Europe has been one of the defining political trends of the past decades (Mudde 2007; Norris and

Inglehart 2019; Kriesi et al. 2008). At the same time, the radical right has become fragmented (Ennser 2012; Ivaldi 2023; De Lange 2022). This paper examined how the rise of nativism intersects with the preexisting centre–periphery cleavage and the competing national attachments that define many federal and regionalized states. We use the case of Catalonia, where its national cleavage crosses the radical right. The political polarization surrounding the national issue, fuelled by the rise of the Catalan independence movement, created a window of opportunity for the radical right. On the one hand, Vox has built its platform on Spanish nationalism, establishing itself as a significant political force in both Spain and Catalonia (Turnbull-Dugarte, Rama, and Santana 2020; Turnbull-Dugarte 2019; Marcos-Marne, Plaza-Colodro, and O’Flynn 2024). In 2024, Aliança Catalana secured parliamentary representation by positioning itself as the most radical pro-Catalan party, with an agenda centred on nativism and Catalan nationalism.

We proposed three research questions. First, what are the key similarities, differences, and competitive dynamics between Aliança Catalana and Vox? We analyse the manifestos of both parties from the 2024 Catalan election to explore the supply side of the radical right in Catalonia. While Vox and Aliança Catalana share similar positions on immigration, law and order, and economic issues, they differ on issues related to gender, LGBT + rights, and climate change. Vox takes a traditionalist stance, whereas AC employs homonationalist and femonationalist rhetoric to reinforce its nativist message. They also diverge sharply on the national cleavage: Vox supports recentralization, while AC advocates Catalan independence. Thus, their relevant differences on both primary issues, mainly the national cleavage, and secondary ones, such as gender and the environment, put both parties closer to the ‘wide-ranging competition’ posed by Piccolino and Puleo (2025).

Our second research question wondered how Catalonia transitioned from the absence of significant radical right parties to the presence of two distinct radical right parties represented in its parliament. We use survey data to identify what drives support for the radical right in Catalonia. Immigration consistently emerges as the central issue driving support for both Vox and AC, as well as vote switching from the traditional Catalan parties to AC. We find no substantial evidence that dissatisfaction with mainstream Catalan nationalist parties over independence explains the shift toward AC. Lastly, the third research question posed how the rise of nativism interacts with the pre-existing centre–periphery cleavage. We find that national identity remains critical in shaping both the supply and demand sides of radical-right politics in Catalonia. On the supply side, AC devotes particular attention to issues closely tied to Catalan nationalism, such as education and culture. On the demand side, voters’ national identity sorts them between AC and Vox when they are concerned about immigration. Moreover, holding radical positions on national attachment may enhance the credibility of the party’s nativist appeals.

Our study has some limitations. The most important is the limited number of AC voters in the available surveys, which requires interpreting the results with caution. Future research, particularly if AC continues to gain traction, should address this limitation by utilizing surveys with a broader set of relevant items to provide a more comprehensive analysis. Moreover, future studies should investigate the relationship between nativism and national attachment more deeply, potentially using experiments to test how the combination of both elements may shape citizens' preferences.

We consider that both Vox and Aliança Catalana are likely to remain influential in Catalonia's political landscape, with AC showing notable potential for growth. Catalonia experiences high levels of immigration, and this issue has become increasingly prominent in the region's political discourse. Unlike in 2008, when immigration concerns faded in the aftermath of the financial crisis, this time the issue is likely to remain salient. Moreover, polarization along the national axis is expected to persist. Although the situation has stabilized since the 2017 crisis, deep divisions remain, and Catalan parties continue to advocate for greater self-government. If the Spanish government fails to honour its agreements with Junts and ERC – or if the conservatives come to power – the territorial conflict may reignite. Moreover, the growing salience of immigration places the Catalan party system closer to the tripolar structure described by Oesch and Rennwald (2018), with the distinctive feature that each pole is split into two parties competing on opposite sides of the national cleavage. Overall, this study makes two key contributions. First, it offers the literature on the radical right the first academic analysis of Aliança Catalana, providing a systematic comparison with Vox, an established actor in the radical right landscape. Second, it contributes to the study of territorial conflict by exploring how the nativist wave intersects with divided national attachments to shape a coherent supply and demand for radical right politics.

Notes

1. *Ills volveria a ganar, con Junts en retroceso y una Aliança disparada* (27/03/2025) LaVanguardia. *El PSC ganaria a la baja, pero el avance ultra haria ingobernable Catalunya* (21/09/2025) LaVanguardia.
2. Junts is the successor organization of the traditional center-right Catalan nationalist coalition *Convergencia i Unió*.
3. Details on the survey and descriptive statistics, are available in Appendix D.
4. Following the CAP guidelines, references to gender equality and LGBT+ rights are coded as Civil Rights, while gender-based violence is coded under Law and Crime.
5. The full regression outputs are available in Appendix D. Due to the limited number of observations relative to the number of potential outcomes and the various categories within the independent variables, we are only able to include the interaction term in the model.
6. The full regression models are available in Appendix E together with descriptive statistics for each of the two sub-samples.

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